Pirate Raiders: Land & Trading Update

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Pirate Raiders now has a land side: you can step off your ship, walk around five explorable 3D ports, trade at market stalls, upgrade and recruit, then walk back to your ship and sail on. Sailing, combat, boarding and progression all still work as before.

The new loop

Every port is a place you walk around, not a menu. A new game now starts on foot at Skull Cove, the pirate port, with a short tutorial.

1. Sail close to any port's berth and press **E** to dock.
2. Press **E** again to go ashore. The captain hops from the wheel onto the pier and the camera swings round behind him.
3. Walk through the town to the market stalls, shipwright, gunsmith, tavern and warehouse.
4. Buy goods cheaply, upgrade the ship, recruit officers and take contracts.
5. Walk back down the pier and press **E** at the gangplank to board.
6. Sail to another port, go ashore and sell for a profit, or hunt merchant ships on the way. Then repeat.

Controls

On foot, movement is relative to the camera. While moored at a berth, **E** goes ashore and **W** sets sail.

Key	At sea	On land
W A S D	Sail and turn	Walk
SHIFT	Speed boost	Run
SPACE	Fire cannons	Jump
E	Board a ship, dock, dig treasure	Talk, shop, board your ship
Q	Switch ammunition	—
TAB or I	Inventory	Inventory
M	World map	Town map

Key	At sea	On land
Mouse drag / wheel	Look around / zoom	Look around / zoom
Esc	Pause	Leave a shop, pause

The five ports

Each port has its own look, its own cheap goods and its own mix of shops. Every one has docks, boats, a walk-in tavern, houses, props, townsfolk and animals.

Port	Type	Look	Cheap here	Shops
Skull Cove	Pirate port	Ramshackle wood, skull rock, watchtower and fort	Pepper, cinnamon, metal, rope, rum	4 stalls, shipwright, gunsmith, tavern, warehouse, hidden black market
Port Royal	Merchant port	Stone town, fountain square, guards, lighthouse	Cloth, clothing, grain	6 stalls, shipwright, armoury, tavern, warehouse, night-only black market
Saltmarsh	Fishing village	Teal roofs, nets, drying racks, rowboats	Fish, meat	3 stalls, small shipwright (basic upgrades only), tavern, warehouse
Goldhaven	Rich port	Marble boulevard, palms, golden statue	Jewellery, gold objects, rare curios	4 fancy stalls, yacht works, gunsmith, tavern, warehouse
Mermaid Lagoon	Remote island	Tiki huts, torches, totem, campfire	Pepper, cinnamon, exotic spices, fruit	3 bamboo stalls, tiki tavern, a hermit selling unique items

Port Royal and Goldhaven are lawful: they won't let you dock at a wanted level of two stars or more. Docking anywhere clears your wanted level.

Trading

Buy low in one port, sail to another and sell high. Each port prices 19 goods differently.

- **Goods:** food (fish, fruit, meat, grain), spices (pepper, cinnamon, exotic), textiles (cloth, silk, clothing), materials (wood, metal, rope), luxury (jewellery, gold objects, rare curios) and contraband (rum, mermaid pearls, kraken ink).
- **Buying:** each stall shows the price per crate, the average across all ports, and the best price elsewhere, so you can see the potential profit before you buy.
- **Selling:** stalls show what you paid and your profit per crate.
- **Prices move:** they drift over time, and every crate you buy or sell nudges the local price up or down.
- **Who buys what:** each stall sells and buys its own kind of goods. The general trader stocks a changing mix and buys almost anything, at a lower rate.
- **Cargo:** your hold has a set capacity, which the shipwright can enlarge. Each port has its own warehouse for storing cargo.
- **Good routes:** Skull Cove pepper to Port Royal, Saltmarsh fish to Goldhaven, Port Royal cloth to Mermaid Lagoon, Goldhaven jewellery to Skull Cove.

Shops and services

You walk up to each one and press **E**. The keeper turns to greet you with a speech bubble, and the shop opens beside them rather than as a full-screen menu.

Place	What you can do
Market stalls	Buy and sell at the food, spice, textile, materials and luxury stalls, and at the general trader
Shipwright	Upgrade hull, sails, steering, cargo hold and crew quarters with a live 3D preview of your ship. Upgrades change the ship's model. Also repairs, sail colours, hull paint and flags
Gunsmith	Cannon models, longer barrels, five ammo types (round, chain, grape, fire, heavy) and cannon skins. Each item lists damage, range, reload and a description
Tavern bartender	Hire deckhands, rent a room to skip to morning or evening, buy a round for rumours and trade tips
Tavern recruits	Officers sitting around the room, each with a name, role (gunner, navigator, engineer, boarder or trader), skill level, cost, special ability and bonus

Place	What you can do
Mission board	Contracts: deliveries, sealed-cargo runs, ship captures, treasure maps, rival pirates and exploration
Warehouse	Store and retrieve cargo, kept separately in each port
Black market	Hidden until you find it. Sells rare goods and special items such as dragon cannons, storm-silk sails, ghost-ship paint, treasure maps, grappling hooks and cursed cutlasses

The inventory (**TAB**) shows money, cargo, equipment, crew and officers, contracts, quest items and treasure found.

Living towns

Townsfolk follow daily schedules tied to the game's day and night cycle.

- **Daytime:** vendors run the stalls, workers carry crates, fishermen fish off the jetties, guards patrol and gossips chat in the square.
- **Evening:** the tavern fills up with drinkers, a fiddler and dancers.
- **Night:** lanterns glow, food, spice, textile and luxury stalls close, and Port Royal's black market opens.
- **Talking:** walk up to anyone and press **E**. They turn to face you and answer with jokes and hints, such as where spices are cheap or where treasure is buried.
- **Animals:** chickens, cats, parrots, goats and crabs. Chickens and crabs scurry away when you run past, and a dog comes over to say hello.
- **Maps:** on land the minimap becomes a town map that turns with the camera, and **M** shows the full town with every shop marked.

Testing

Everything was checked in a headless browser using software rendering, with scripted runs and screenshots. The production build passes and a fresh load shows no console errors or warnings.

Check	Result
Trade run	Bought 10 pepper at Skull Cove for $372, sailed to Port Royal, docked, went ashore and sold for $617: a $245 profit
Sea run (autopilot)	Captured a merchant at 15 seconds, money went from $1,000 to $1,837, then docked at Skull Cove at 49 seconds and went ashore
All five ports	Walked ashore in each; buildings, stalls, townsfolk and maps checked by screenshot
Every shop screen	Stalls, black market, shipwright, gunsmith, tavern, recruits, mission board, warehouse and inventory
Night and dialogue	Lanterns, closing stalls, a busy tavern and townsfolk conversations
Rival pirate	The rival brig hunts you down and fights back

Fixes made during testing:

- Moved buildings in Goldhaven and Port Royal that had been placed partly in the water.
- Pulled the shop camera out to the side so the captain no longer blocks the vendor.
- Made Skull Cove's spices cheap so the opening trade run pays off.
- Toned down the rival pirate, who sank a starting ship too easily.

Notes and how to run it

- **Performance:** frame rate wasn't measured on a real graphics card. Loading takes about 3 seconds longer than before, and the automatic graphics setting steps down if walking around town runs slowly.
- **Not every port has every shop:** the fishing village has no gunsmith, and the remote island has no shipwright, gunsmith or warehouse.
- **Black markets** are hidden back-alley rooms rather than underground rooms.
- **Saves carry over:** old cargo converts to the new goods, and a saved game resumes on foot at the last port visited.

To run the game, install Node.js, then in the project folder run:

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

Then open http://localhost:5173 in a browser. The README in the project covers the controls, ports and trading tips.